



Behavioral Health Industry Glossary

Webserv specializes in serving the behavioral health industry (defined below). Therefore, when engaging with clients, it's crucial to be not only well-versed in PPC but also knowledgeable about the industry itself. This dual expertise fosters trust with clients, demonstrating your understanding of their business objectives and the intricacies of their industry. Therefore, we request that you thoroughly review this glossary and don't hesitate to ask any questions you might have!

- **Behavioral Health (BH):** Behavioral health encompasses the psychological, emotional, and social well-being of individuals, focusing on the connection between thoughts, feelings, and behaviors. *It includes the prevention, diagnosis, and treatment of mental health disorders, substance abuse disorders, and other behavioral challenges.* Behavioral health services address a wide range of conditions, including depression, anxiety, bipolar disorder, schizophrenia, addiction, and trauma-related disorders, through various therapeutic interventions, counseling, and support programs.
- **Mental Health Treatment:** Mental health treatment encompasses a range of interventions and services aimed at addressing mental health disorders, emotional difficulties, and psychological distress. It involves various therapeutic approaches, including counseling, psychotherapy, medication management, and holistic interventions, to promote psychological well-being and alleviate symptoms. Treatment may be provided in various settings, including outpatient clinics, inpatient facilities, and through telehealth platforms.
- **Dual Diagnosis Treatment:** Dual diagnosis, also known as co-occurring disorders, refers to the presence of both a substance use disorder (primary issue) and a mental health disorder (secondary issue) in an individual. This term encompasses a wide range of combinations, such as depression and

alcoholism, anxiety and opioid addiction, or bipolar disorder and cocaine dependence. Dual diagnosis requires specialized treatment approaches that address both the mental health and substance use aspects concurrently. Effective treatment often involves integrated interventions that target both disorders simultaneously, such as dual diagnosis therapy, medication management, substance abuse counseling, psychoeducation, and relapse prevention strategies.

- **Addiction / Substance Use Disorder (SUD) Treatment:** Refers to the therapeutic interventions and support services aimed at addressing substance abuse disorders and related behavioral issues. Treatment modalities may include counseling, medication-assisted treatment, detoxification, inpatient or outpatient treatment, and ongoing support to achieve recovery and sobriety. Given the sensitive nature of this subject, it must be approached with utmost care. In fact, due to the sensitive nature of addiction treatment and the importance of maintaining HIPAA compliance, the use of retargeting in these campaigns is prohibited.
- **HIPAA Compliance:** HIPAA (Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act) compliance involves adhering to federal regulations that protect the privacy and security of individuals' health information. In behavioral health digital marketing, maintaining HIPAA compliance is essential when collecting, storing, or transmitting sensitive patient data through websites, forms, or communication channels.
 - **PHI (Protected Health Information):** refers to any individually identifiable health information that is created, received, maintained, or transmitted by a healthcare provider, health plan, healthcare clearinghouse, or their business associates. This includes demographic information, medical history, test results, insurance information, and other data that can be used to identify an individual and relates to their past, present, or future physical or mental health or condition. PHI is subject to strict privacy and security regulations under HIPAA.
- **LegitScript:** Legitscript is a verification and monitoring service that certifies addiction treatment providers. Legitscript certification ensures compliance with legal and regulatory standards for advertising and providing addiction

treatment services online. All clients who want to advertise on Meta, Google Ads, or Microsoft must have this certification.

- **Payer-Mix:** Payer-mix refers to the composition of payment sources utilized by patients receiving behavioral health services. It analyzes the proportion of payments coming from various sources such as private insurance, government-funded programs like Medicaid and Medicare, self-pay, or other third-party payers.
- **Private Pay:** also known as cash pay, denotes the payment approach for accessing behavioral health services. In lieu of utilizing insurance (in cases where the individual lacks coverage or the facility does not accept their insurance policy), payment is made directly in cash to receive treatment.
- **Private Insurance:** Private insurance refers to health insurance plans provided by private companies or employers. These plans are typically obtained through employment benefits or purchased individually and offer coverage for various medical services, including behavioral health and addiction treatment. Most of our clients only accept private insurance (or cash pay). Note that there are private insurances that are HMO or PPO (preferred by most clients) policies, as well as in-network and out-of-network (preferred by most clients) policies. *Some common insurances consist of: Blue Cross Blue Shield (BCBS), Aetna, Cigna, Magellan, Beacon, Magellan Health, MultiPlan, Value Options, UMR, and Anthem Blue Cross.*
 - **Preferred Provider Organization (PPO):** is a type of health insurance plan that allows members to visit any healthcare provider or specialist without a referral, including both in-network and out-of-network providers. However, members typically pay less out-of-pocket when they receive services from healthcare providers within the plan's network. PPO plans offer greater flexibility and choice in healthcare providers but may have higher premiums and out-of-pocket costs compared to other types of plans. This is a preferred policy for most clients.
 - **Health Maintenance Organization (HMO):** is a type of health insurance plan that typically requires members to select a primary care physician (PCP) from a network of healthcare providers. In HMO plans, members must obtain referrals from their PCP to see specialists or receive additional services within the network. Generally, HMO plans offer lower premiums

and out-of-pocket costs compared to PPO plans but have more restricted provider networks and require greater coordination of care through the PCP. Usually our clients don't get good payouts from HMO plans and prefer PPO plans instead.

- **Exclusive Provider Organization (EPO):** is a type of health insurance plan where individuals receive coverage only if they use doctors, specialists, or hospitals that are part of the plan's network, except in cases of emergency. Unlike an HMO (Health Maintenance Organization), an EPO typically doesn't require referrals to see specialists. However, if you seek care outside of the network, except for emergencies, you'll likely have to pay the full cost yourself. EPO plans generally offer lower premiums compared to PPOs (Preferred Provider Organizations) but have less flexibility in terms of provider choice.
- **Point of Service (POS)** insurance is a hybrid health plan blending HMO and PPO features, letting you use a Primary Care Provider (PCP) for lower costs within a network, but also offering flexibility to see out-of-network providers (at a higher cost) without a referral, though you'll pay more out-of-pocket. The "point of service" refers to your choice at the time of care: stay in-network for better coverage or go out-of-network for more choice, usually requiring a PCP referral for specialists.
- **In-Network (INN):** refers to healthcare providers, hospitals, and other medical facilities that have contracted with a specific health insurance plan to provide services to its members at negotiated rates. When members receive care from in-network providers, they typically pay lower out-of-pocket costs, such as copayments, coinsurance, and deductibles, as negotiated rates are often lower than the provider's standard charges.
- **Out-of-Network (OON):** refers to healthcare providers, hospitals, and medical facilities that do not have a contract with a specific health insurance plan. When members receive care from out-of-network providers, they may incur higher out-of-pocket costs, as the insurance plan may cover a smaller portion of the expenses or apply higher deductibles, coinsurance, and copayments. Out-of-network care may also require members to pay the full cost upfront and seek reimbursement from the insurance company later.

- **Single Case Agreement (SCA):** When provider is approved for a *single case agreement* by insurance to honor single case PPO benefits. These cases typically still charge the treated client as they would HMO – low deductible and out-of-pocket costs. The billed amount by provider, paid for by insurance is typically closer to PPO bills. Though it's important to note that these are *very* rare and typically only centers that meet a speciality need of which none of their in-network providers can meet (typically within 20-40 miles). An example may be a women's-only residential eating disorder treatment (very niche).
- **Medicaid:** Medicaid is a joint federal and state program that provides health insurance coverage to low-income individuals and families. It offers comprehensive benefits, including behavioral health services, to eligible individuals who meet specific income and eligibility criteria determined by each state. And the state may even delegate county-specific plans. These plans are usually not the type of insurance our clients accept.
 - **Medi-Cal:** is California's Medicaid program, offering free or low-cost health insurance coverage to eligible low-income individuals and families. Some counties in California do have county-specific divisions, potentially partnered with and carved out through other insurance providers.
- **Medicare:** is a federal health insurance program primarily for individuals aged 65 and older, as well as certain younger individuals with disabilities or end-stage renal disease. There are also Medicare extensions carved out through private market insurance providers – allowing more options and additional coverage. Even with Medicare extension plans, these plans are usually not the type of insurance our clients accept.
- **TRICARE:** is the healthcare program serving uniformed service members, veterans, retirees, and their families worldwide – a division of the Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) . It offers comprehensive coverage, including medical, dental, and prescription services, with different plans tailored to the needs of active-duty members, reservists, and veterans. Some clients have contracts with TRICARE and are specifically seeking veterans and active duty members as potential patients.
 - **TriWest:** is a separate organization that administers the Tricare West Region health plan on behalf of the Department of Defense. TriWest acts as a contractor responsible for managing healthcare services and

networks for Tricare beneficiaries in the Western United States. This includes coordinating access to care, processing claims, and providing customer service to Tricare beneficiaries in the region.

- **COBRA:** is a federal law that allows eligible employees and their dependents to continue their group health insurance coverage for a limited period after experiencing certain qualifying events, such as job loss or reduction in hours. It enables individuals to maintain access to behavioral health benefits temporarily, albeit at their own expense. This is important because if someone loses their job, they may still qualify for treatment with their private insurance for up to six months.
- **VOB (Verification of Benefits):** is the process of confirming a patient's insurance coverage and understanding the extent of their benefits for behavioral health services. It involves verifying eligibility, coverage limits, copayments, deductibles, and any pre-authorization requirements before initiating treatment. Usually our clients' admissions team run VOBs for leads who have private insurance - this is the type of lead we want to generate!
 - Most of our clients do a **"soft" VOB** with a tool like Verify Tx so they can get basic knowledge of the plan (IE carved through Medicaid). They may contact their billing company or have an additional tool to develop foresight of an insurance payout *percentage paid* or *max billable rate*.
 - We traditionally do not qualify Medicaid-insured leads as VOBs, as most of our clients do not accept Medicaid.
- **Viable VOB (AKA Approved VOB):** refers to a successful verification of benefits process that confirms a patient's insurance coverage and determines the feasibility of utilizing their benefits for behavioral health treatment. It ensures that the patient's insurance plan adequately covers the necessary services without significant financial barriers. Usually our clients' admissions team run VOBs for leads who have private insurance - this is the type of lead we want to generate even more so as the client is probably in-network or the policy is a PPO policy!
- **Admit:** Admitting a patient refers to the process of formally admitting them into a behavioral health treatment program or facility. This is what we strive

for, though we don't have control of this - we can only try to bring our clients VOBs and viable VOBs, it is up to the admission team to close these.

- **Against Medical Advice (AMA):** When a patient goes *against medical advice*, they discontinue treatment which means the treating facility will not get paid for the remaining recommended days of treatment — as billing is done on a per day basis. Typically AMA discharges are from treatment facilities locally-based patients.
- **Continuum of Care:** The continuum of care in behavioral health emphasizes the coordinated delivery of services across different levels and settings to meet the diverse needs of individuals throughout their recovery journey. It encompasses a comprehensive range of services, including prevention, early intervention, outpatient therapy, intensive outpatient programs, partial hospitalization, inpatient treatment, residential care, transitional living, and ongoing support in the community. The goal of the continuum of care is to ensure that individuals receive the appropriate level of care at each stage of their recovery, with seamless transitions between services to optimize mental health outcomes and enhance the overall treatment experience.
- **Levels of Care:** Levels of care refer to the various stages and intensities of treatment available for individuals seeking behavioral health services. These levels are designed to match the severity of the individual's symptoms, the complexity of their needs, and their readiness for change. Commonly recognized levels of care in behavioral health treatment include inpatient/residential treatment, detox, MAT, PHP, IOP, OP, sober living, and after care.
 - **Inpatient/Residential Treatment:** Inpatient or residential treatment involves intensive, 24-hour care provided in a structured environment/home for 30, 60 and even 90 days. It is typically recommended for individuals with severe substance abuse disorders or mental health conditions requiring constant supervision and support. These facilities are accessible to individuals from across the US, offering a significant advantage as it allows individuals to distance themselves from environments often filled with people and places associated with their illness in a negative manner (this a huge selling point to convince people to travel to facilities far from their location).

- **Detoxification:** commonly referred to as detox, is the process of removing toxins, particularly drugs or alcohol, from the body while managing withdrawal symptoms in a safe and controlled environment. Detoxification is often the first step in substance abuse treatment, aiming to achieve physical stabilization and prepare individuals for further rehabilitation. Medical supervision and support are essential during detox to ensure safety and comfort, as withdrawal symptoms can be severe and potentially life-threatening. This treatment can last from three to eight+ days.
- **Partial Hospitalization Program (PHP):** Partial hospitalization programs provide structured, day-long treatment and support services for individuals who require intensive therapy and monitoring but do not need 24-hour care. PHPs offer a comprehensive range of therapeutic interventions, including group therapy, individual counseling, medication management, and psychiatric support, while allowing patients to return home or to a supportive living environment in the evenings.
 - **Florida Model: PHP with sober living homes near by the treatment facility (technically residential, but can't be called residential due to licensing)**
- **Intensive Outpatient Program (IOP):** Intensive outpatient programs offer structured treatment and support services while allowing individuals to live at home or in a supportive environment like a sober living home. IOPs typically involve several hours of therapy sessions per day, multiple times per week, allowing patients to maintain their daily routines while receiving intensive treatment for substance abuse disorders or mental health conditions. IOPs may include group therapy, individual counseling, psychoeducation, and relapse prevention strategies.
- **Outpatient Treatment:** Outpatient treatment provides flexible, part-time therapy and support services for individuals with mild to moderate substance abuse disorders or mental health conditions. Outpatient services may include individual counseling, group therapy, medication management, and psychiatric support, scheduled at regular intervals based on the individual's needs and progress. Outpatient treatment allows patients to continue their daily activities while receiving ongoing therapeutic support and monitoring.

- **Telehealth:** is a way to receive healthcare services remotely, using telecommunications technology like video calls or mobile apps, instead of visiting a healthcare provider in person. Behavioral health centers will have to be licensed to provide these services, however, licenses are only given at the state level meaning only people within the state the facility is located in can receive telehealth services.
- **Medication-Assisted Treatment (MAT):** is an evidence-based approach to treating substance use disorders that combines medication with behavioral therapy and support services. MAT involves the use of FDA-approved medications, such as suboxone, methadone, buprenorphine, or naltrexone, to reduce cravings, alleviate withdrawal symptoms, and promote recovery from opioid or alcohol dependence. This treatment can be part of the detox process, or sometimes it can be done through an outpatient program.
- **Sober Living:** Sober living homes, also known as halfway houses or transitional living facilities, offer individuals in recovery from substance use disorders a supportive and drug-free environment to continue their journey towards sobriety. These homes provide a structured setting where residents adhere to strict rules regarding abstinence from drugs and alcohol, while also fostering a sense of community and peer support among residents who share similar goals.
- **Aftercare:** Aftercare in behavioral health refers to the support and treatment provided to individuals after they have completed an initial phase of therapy, rehabilitation, or other behavioral health interventions. It focuses on helping individuals transition back into their daily lives and maintaining progress towards recovery from conditions such as substance abuse, mental health disorders, or trauma. Aftercare services may include follow-up appointments, counseling sessions, support groups, medication management, vocational assistance, housing support, or other resources aimed at promoting long-term mental health and wellness.
- **Holistic Treatment:** Holistic treatment may be a phrase you see a client use to describe their therapies/modalities (a selling point). This treatment approach emphasizes the interconnectedness of the mind, body, and spirit in promoting health and wellness. Holistic treatment for mental health and substance use disorders encompasses a comprehensive array of interventions that address

various dimensions of an individual's well-being, including physical, emotional, social, and spiritual aspects. These approaches recognize the importance of treating the whole person rather than focusing solely on symptoms or diagnoses. Holistic treatment modalities may include mindfulness-based practices, meditation, yoga, art therapy, nutrition counseling, exercise therapy, acupuncture, and massage therapy, among others.